



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's try the Toastmaster's Club!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- Is it easy for you to speak in public?
Why or why not?
- If you were going to make a speech in public on any topic, what would you talk about?

Can Do Statements

- I can express beliefs, opinions, and annoyance.
- I can report details, reasons, or results of events or actions.
- I can talk about present or past habits.





Let's Explore!

Gareth tries to convince Tammy to give a **speech*** in public. Yikes!

* A "speech" is a formal message delivered by speaking. Your speech is also the way you talk.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Gareth:** Hi Tammy! I haven't seen you in such a long time!
- Tammy:** Yeah, ever since my twin sister and your best friend broke up.
- Gareth:** A best friend will be unpredictable sometimes.
- Tammy:** He sent a Valentine's message to his ex-girlfriend.
- Gareth:** Can you believe that? Frank would do something like that, wouldn't he? It's so typical of him! That might explain why she broke up with him.
- Tammy:** Ah yeah ... just a little.
- Gareth:** In any case, it wasn't my fault, right? I'm sure we will still get along like before.
- Tammy:** I guess. A sister will do what she has to do.
- Gareth:** What have you been up to these days?
- Tammy:** I've been looking for a job, but it's been really hard. I get shy in interviews.
- Gareth:** I know what you're saying. I have something you might be interested in.
- Tammy:** What is it?
- Gareth:** I have decided to join the local Toastmaster's Club. It's a group that helps you practice public speaking. I believe that it will help me build my confidence for speaking in public.
- Tammy:** My neighbor used to do that. He would practice his speeches every evening. That explains why it looked like he was talking to himself. What do people talk about?
- Gareth:** The speeches are unpredictable. It's up to each individual to prepare their own speech. I haven't decided what to talk about yet.
- Tammy:** It takes a courageous person to speak in front of a group of strangers like that.
- Gareth:** After your speech, there is a short period for questions and answers.
- Tammy:** I suspect it must be difficult to prepare for that.
- Gareth:** Yes, you never know what someone might ask you. The question could be only indirectly related to your topic. You have to be very adaptable. You should try it!
- Tammy:** I don't know!



Let's Practice!

It's not easy to express opinions!

Instructions: Choose the option that best completes the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) It's so _____ of him. He will always do the same thing.
 - a) typical
 - b) logical
 - c) skeptical
- 2) I _____ it must be difficult to prepare for that. I haven't had that kind of experience.
 - a) think
 - b) respect
 - c) suspect
- 3) During a speech, someone might ask you anything. You have to be very _____ to it.
 - a) adapter
 - b) adaptable
 - c) capable
- 4) I believe that it will help me build my _____ for speaking in public.
 - a) residence
 - b) confidence
 - c) patience
- 5) It takes a _____ person to speak in front of a group of strangers like that.
 - a) courageous
 - b) gorgeous
 - c) Courage



Let's Practice!

It might be your fault!

Instructions: Proofread the sentences below and circle the mistakes you find. Correct the sentences.

- 1) My neighbor use to do that.
- 2) He would be practiced his speeches every evening.
- 3) Frank would doing something like that, wouldn't he?
- 4) A sister will doing what she has to do.
- 5) A best friend will being unpredictable sometimes.





Extension Activity

Read an interesting speech and tell someone what you read.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online. Find a speech in English on a topic you are interested in.
- Read or listen to the speech.
- Take notes on the main ideas in the speech.
- Tell a partner what you learned from the speech.
- Make a comparative chart in which you include weaknesses and strengths of the speech.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I read a speech in English.

☐ ☐

I write notes from the speech.

☐ ☐

I retell the speech to a partner in my own words.

☐ ☐

I discuss the good and bad points about the speech.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **toastmaster** (noun): a person who speaks in front of a large group
e.g. I have decided to join the local Toastmaster's Club.
- **twin** (noun): a person born at the same time to the same mother as another person
e.g. Yeah, ever since my twin sister and your best friend broke up.
- **confidence** (noun): feeling of respect for yourself
e.g. I believe that it will help me build my confidence for speaking in public.
- **public speaking** (noun): the action of talking in front of a group of people in a formal setting
e.g. Toastmasters is a group that helps you practice public speaking.
- **unpredictable** (adjective): difficult to anticipate
e.g. The speeches are unpredictable.
- **stranger** (noun): a person you do not know
e.g. It takes a courageous person to speak in front of a group of strangers like that.





Learning Points

The Wh-Clause

In speaking, you often use wh-words to ask information questions. These words can also be used to begin a clause after certain verbs.

These wh-words can be pronouns (**who, whom, whose, what, which, that**) or adverbs (**when, where, why, how**). **That** is sometimes used in place of **which** or **who**.

Some verbs that can be followed by wh-words are:

know	see	discuss	determine
understand	find out	guess	debate
remember	imagine	forget	choose
decide	plan	wonder	discover
notice	explain	realize	say

Examples:

*I didn't understand **what** I saw in the YouTube video because the images were so blurry.
I forgot my lunch and only remembered **when** I had already arrived at school.*

You could also use many of these verbs with a *that*-clause or a *wh*-clause + infinitive (to + verb).

The *wh*-clause + infinitive cannot be used with **why**. Also, you don't use an infinitive if there is a subject in the *wh*-clause.

Examples:

*Every time I saw the scar on my forehead, I remembered **that** I fell off the swing.*

*Julia couldn't decide **which** dress to wear to the graduation party.
My boyfriend is quite blunt and always says **what** he thinks.*

Examples:

- *I haven't decided what to talk about yet.*
- *I know what you're saying.*

Modals to Describe Present and Past Habits

You can talk about habits in the present and the past using special modal verbs like *will*, *would* and *used to*. These modals are followed by the simple form of the verb (the infinitive with "to").

One way of talking about present habits is to use the Present Simple.

I brush my teeth every night before I go to bed.





Learning Points

You can also use **will** to talk about habits and routines. **Will** can also be used to talk about how something naturally acts or the characteristics of a person.

- *My brother **will** always go to the Bahamas on vacation. He likes tropical weather and relaxing on the beach. (habit or routine)*
- *A good doctor **will** try to make a patient feel comfortable. (characteristic)*
- *Dogs **will** bark when they sense danger. (natural behavior)*

If you want to express your annoyance about a habit, you can use **will**, **will not** or **won't**. In speaking, you need to place more stress on the **not** in the negative **will not**.

- *My grandmother **will** always insist that I eat something even if I'm not hungry.*
- *My friend **will not** quit smoking even though he knows it's bad for his health.*

Used to is for past habits or states. You would probably use this expression most often when talking about your childhood or when you were younger. This is for states or routines that happened frequently in the past. It also means that the habit or state has changed and that you no longer do this action. Because you can use **used to** for states and habits, it can be followed by action verbs and stative verbs.

- *I **used to** go to ballet lessons every Thursday. (action verb)*
- *I **used to** hate eating broccoli when I was a child. (stative verb)*

For negatives and questions, the form of **used to** is different.

- *I **didn't use to** go to the gym in university.*
- ***Did** you **use to** like cartoons when you were younger?*

You can use **would** for recurring actions in the past as well. However, this cannot be used with past states, and is only used with action verbs. This is often shortened to 'd in speaking.

- *I **would** go to ballet lessons every Thursday. (action verb)*
- *I **used to** hate eating broccoli when I was a child. (stative verb, so cannot use would)*

Examples:

- *My neighbor used to do that.*
- *He would be practicing his speeches every evening.*

